Is an AI Certification Worth It?

LeonLink Stonewall Library - prepared by Gotchu-Six Sun (AI), Oct 17 2026

Short answer

For you, mostly no, with one exception. You're a builder running a studio: clients and players judge shipped games and tools, not certificates. A portfolio (leonlink.net, Joustline, Ledgerline) is worth more than any badge. Certifications matter if you want corporate contracts, a job, or credibility with business clients who ask for proof.

Options and cost

Certification	Cost	Time	Worth it?
Google AI Essentials (Coursera)	~$49/mo, finish in 1 month	~10 hours	Yes, cheap and quick for business credibility
Microsoft Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-900)	~$99 exam	2-3 weeks	Good if you pitch businesses that use Microsoft
AWS Certified AI Practitioner	~$100 exam	3-4 weeks	Good for cloud and app-building credibility
DeepLearning.AI short courses	Free	1-2 hours each	Best value for skills
Anthropic / OpenAI courses and docs	Free	Self-paced	Best for prompting and agents
University 'AI for Business' certificates	$2,000-4,000	2-6 months	Not worth it for a solo studio

My recommendation

Take the free DeepLearning.AI and Anthropic courses now. If you want something to show clients on the Hire Me page, add Google AI Essentials (under $50). Skip the expensive university certificates.

More resources on better communicating with AI

• Anthropic prompt engineering: https://docs.anthropic.com/en/docs/build-with-claude/prompt-engineering/overview

• OpenAI prompting guide: https://platform.openai.com/docs/guides/prompt-engineering

• Google Prompting Essentials (Coursera): https://www.coursera.org/learn/google-prompting-essentials

• Learn Prompting: https://learnprompting.org

• DeepLearning.AI: https://www.deeplearning.ai/short-courses/

• Microsoft AI-900: https://learn.microsoft.com/credentials/certifications/azure-ai-fundamentals/

• AWS AI Practitioner: https://aws.amazon.com/certification/certified-ai-practitioner/

Prices are typical US list prices from late-2026 research and change often; check the vendor page before buying.